RESEARCH SYNTHESIS

EU compliance brain: the scoping gap is open

Is there a market for a tool that tells a company which EU acts apply to it and what is still open?

DATE

14 October 2026

SCOPE

EU-wide, any company size, horizontal. Starting set:

GDPR | AI Act | NIS2 | DORA | CRA | CSRD | Data Act | Product Liability

NOTES

Bracketed numbers refer to the Sources list.

Verdict

Yes, there is a market, but it is for the scoping job, not for another checklist. Every incumbent makes the customer pick frameworks or modules. None found derives "which EU acts apply to us and what is still open" from a company's footprint, and none publishes a per-obligation lawyer sign-off.

The closest players each hold one piece: Justima has law-firm-backed monitoring, Norm Ai has lawyer-supervised agents (US finance only), LexisNexis has lawyer-authored registers (UK-centric) and C2P has expert-curated product rules.

The densest demand sits in the 50 to 1,000 employee band, where NIS2, CRA, AI Act, Data Act and GDPR overlap and in-house legal capacity is thin. The hard problems are not demand. They are legal liability for company-specific answers, and the chance that law firms keep this layer for themselves.

Does someone already do it?

CLOSEST marks the four players the verdict names as closest. Scroll sideways on small screens.

PLAYER	ORIGIN AND FUNDING	WHAT THEY DO	HOW CONTENT IS VERIFIED

Justima CLOSEST	Osborne Clarke spin-off, launched May 2026; OC majority *(snippet)*; funding undisclosed [1]	Agents monitor 200+ sources daily, push only relevant changes	OC is exclusive expertise partner; lawyers step in "where judgement... is required"
Norm Ai CLOSEST	New York; $120M Series C Jul 2026 at $1.2B, $260M+ total [2]	Compliance agents plus own AI-native law firm, Norm Law LLP	Senior attorneys "supervise, calibrate and improve" agents
LexisNexis Regulatory Compliance CLOSEST	RELX	Obligation registers: modules, obligations, sub-obligations, alerts, Protégé AI [3]	Written by named barristers and partners (Norton Rose Fulbright, CMS)
Compliance & Risks (C2P) CLOSEST	Cork; funding not found	70k to 95k regulation library *(vendor claim)*; AI-native platform linking obligations to products, previewed Jun 2026 [4]	40+ in-house regulatory specialists, "expert-in-the-loop"; no lawyers
CUBE	London; Hg-backed since 2024; bought TR Regulatory Intelligence, Kodex AI, 4CRisk [5][6]	Regulatory feed plus agentic impact mapping; ServiceNow connector	Analyst-curated feed
Regology	US; acquired by Bloomberg Industry Group Jun 2026 [7]	"Smart Law Library" tailored per client, linked to controls	Not stated
heyData	Berlin; $16.5M Series A Jan 2026 [9]	External DPO plus platform	"Certified compliance experts on demand"
DataGuard	Munich; ~€61M Series B 2022 [11]	Platform plus experts-in-the-loop, external DPO/ISO, "Global Legal Analysis" add-on	Experts, no lawyer sign-off described
Secjur	Hamburg; €5.5M seed 2022 [12]	Step-by-step self-service assistant	"Certified experts" on request
Kertos	Munich; €14M Series A Sep 2025 [13]	AI assistant for risk assessments, policies, vendor reviews	Not stated
Vanta	US; $150M Series D 2025 at $4.15B [14]	Control and evidence automation; agentic platform since Nov 2025	Control templates; NIS2 mapped onto ISO 27001 controls [15]

Hybridity	Stockholm; ~€5M total [16]	"Hy5" with traceability and "legal engineering"	Not stated
Cleo Labs	Paris; €1.5M pre-seed Apr 2026 [17]	"MARIA" agents track 25,000 authorities *(vendor claim)*	Legal experts validate output [16]
OneTrust	US	DataGuidance research plus GRC modules, Copilot Q&A [18]	1,700+ legal contributors *(vendor claim)*; research, not a signed register

How they do it

- **Framework checklists.** SME tools (heyData, Secjur, Kertos, DataGuard) sell a list of frameworks the customer opts into. Scoping is the customer's or the DPO's job.
- **Alert-to-control mapping.** ServiceNow, CUBE and Archer use agents to map incoming regulatory alerts onto an existing control library, read-only and with human approval [20]. They never decide applicability from scratch.
- **External DPO as the human layer.** In DACH the expert who does the reasoning is a bundled outsourced DPO, backed by that person's professional indemnity insurance.
- **Lawyer-authored obligation registers.** LexisNexis is the only true example, matched by "industry and location" modules, not by company facts [3].
- **Law-firm spin-offs and stakes.** Osborne Clarke spun off Justima, Norm built its own firm, and CMS and Dentons invested in Noxtua [21].

Business models observed

- **DPO-as-a-service subscription:** heyData €59 to €159/month *(aggregator)*; Proliance €125 to €450/month plus €500 to €2,000 audits [22].
- **Per-framework SaaS by quote:** Drata entry about $7.5k, Vendr median about $25k/yr [23]; each extra framework $3k to $10k *(aggregator)* [24].
- **Usage-metered AI:** KaitoSec €240/month for 100 AI calls, €575 for 500 *(aggregator)* [15].
- **Per-seat regulatory intelligence:** Regology $1,700/user/month *(aggregator)*.
- **Enterprise GRC:** ServiceNow all-in $150k to $400k for 200 to 1,000 staff *(competitor blog)* [19].

- **Legal texts with liability takeover:** Trusted Shops €24.90/month, covering warning-letter costs via partner firm WBS [25].
- **Outcome-priced law firm:** Norm Law.
- **Benchmark to beat:** German business lawyers at €300 to €400/hour, so a multi-act scoping costs an estimated €6k to €24k *(our estimate)*.

Demand signals

- **NIS2 covers about 160,000 EU entities** [26]. Germany expects about 29,500, but only about 18,500 had registered by May 2026 [27] *(law-firm sources)*.

  Caveat: a secondary citation of the Commission's impact assessment.
- **22% of in-scope firms do not know whether NIS2 applies, and 16% are fully compliant** [28].

  Caveat: a vendor survey of 670 leaders.
- **German SMEs score 56/100 on AI Act awareness versus 82/100 on GDPR** [29].

  Caveat: one academic study, reported secondhand.
- **97% of German firms with 20+ staff report a high data-protection burden** [30].

  Caveat: Bitkom lobbies for reform, and the figure is self-reported.
- **The Omnibus effect cuts both ways.** CSRD now hits only firms above 1,000 staff and €450m turnover [31], and ESG software saw 11 M&A deals in nine months *(analyst blog)* [32]. Meanwhile AI Act high-risk dates moved to Dec 2027, and the GDPR/Data Act Digital Omnibus is still stuck in Council [33].

  Caveat: no study measures the resulting confusion.
- **European eGRC software: about $6.0bn (2025) to $12.6bn (2030)** [34].

  Caveat: a search snippet, and nobody sizes the applicability niche.

How to be different

1. **Sell the applicability verdict, not modules.** Footprint scan, then targeted questions, then a per-act "applies / doesn't / depends on X" with the reasoning chain. The only official tool, the EU AI Act checker, covers one act and is "light on decision support" [35].
2. **Publish provenance per obligation.** Show the article and recital link (EUR-Lex is free), the signing lawyer, the date and the version. No vendor discloses sign-off granularity, so this is checkable proof, not a slogan.
3. **One obligation graph across acts.** Dedupe overlaps such as NIS2 vs DORA lex

specialis and the parallel CRA, NIS2 and GDPR incident clocks. CRA 24h/72h reporting has applied since Sept 2026 [36]. Competitors run siloed modules.

4. **A multi-firm network per member state.** NIS2 and the PLD are directives with national transpositions. Justima's single exclusive firm cannot sign off 27 versions; a network of local firms can.
5. **The law firm as channel, not cost.** Escalate cases needing judgement into a partner-firm mandate, as eRecht24 and Trusted Shops do. NisAI already runs a law-firm partner programme [37].
6. **Price at the DPO anchor.** Around €3k to €15k a year for the 50 to 1,000 band undercuts a one-off lawyer scoping and covers eight acts.

RISKS

- **RDG limits.** Standardised content is safe under BGH Smartlaw [38]. Company-specific AI output is untested in court [39], and outside capital cannot own a law firm [40]. "Rechtssicher" marketing also invites UWG exposure.
- **Hallucination liability.** Stanford found 17% to 34% error rates in leading legal AI [41]. Nobody insures multi-act applicability conclusions, and fines run to €10m or 2% under NIS2.
- **Law firms keep the layer.** Osborne Clarke already spun off Justima. Harvey (about $11bn to $15.5bn) and Legora (about $5.6bn) sit inside the very firms you need for sign-off [42].

Recommended next domain

Product safety and market access (GPSR, Machinery Regulation, Radio Equipment Directive). CRA and PLD already force the agent to establish whether a company puts products or software on the market, so this reuses the same facts for the same manufacturer-heavy mid-market. The ESG regimes, by contrast, lost most of their scope under Omnibus I.

Caveat: this research did not cover GPSR in depth, and C2P and Assent own the enterprise end.